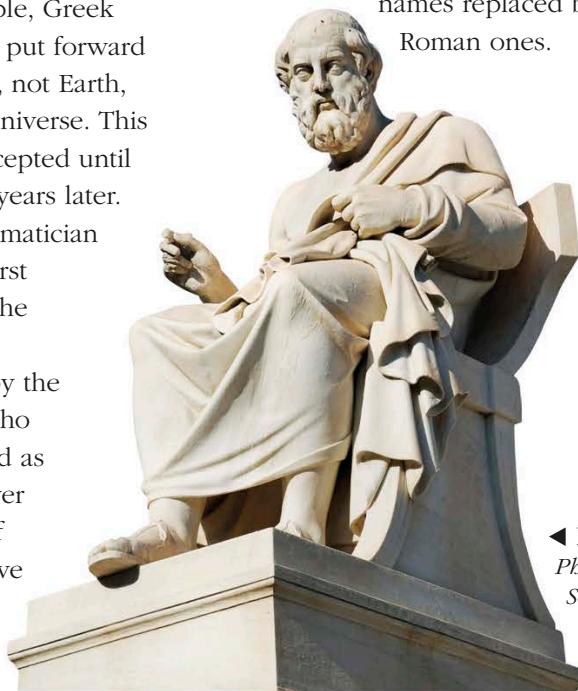


ANCIENT GREEK CULTURE

Ancient Greece produced a thriving and influential culture. Some of the scientific ideas to come out of the region were very advanced for the time. For example, Greek astronomer Aristarchus put forward the theory that the sun, not Earth, was the center of the universe. This fact was not widely accepted until more than a thousand years later. Additionally, the mathematician Eratosthenes was the first to accurately estimate the circumference of Earth.

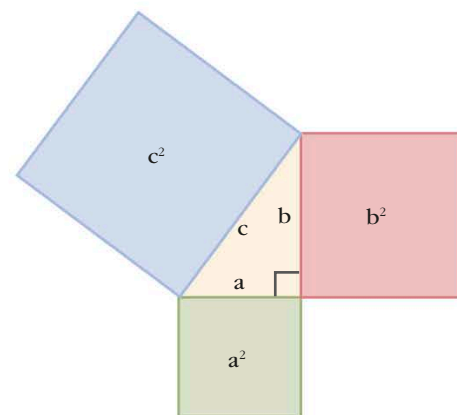
In literature, works by the poets Homer and Sappho continue to be regarded as some of the greatest ever written. The writings of Greek philosophers have had a major impact on Western thinking and culture. Even

after the Roman conquest, Greek culture continued its influence. Pre-Christian Roman beliefs, for example, were based on Greek mythology, but with Greek names replaced by Roman ones.



▼ SCIENCE AND MATHEMATICS

The ancient Greeks knew of seven planets in the solar system and had names for 48 constellations, 47 of which are still recognized. Pythagoras's theorem, which explains the relationship between the lengths of a right-angled triangle's sides, was also developed in ancient Greece.



◀ PHILOSOPHY

Philosophers such as Thales of Miletus, Plato (left), Socrates, and Aristotle wrote about what it meant to be human, and about how humans should behave. Their works were so influential that they still form the basis of modern Western philosophy.



▲ MYTHOLOGY

The religion of ancient Greece had a rich and complex mythology. The Greeks worshipped many gods and goddesses, the most important of which were known as the 12 Olympians. Each Olympian represented a different aspect of life—such as war, music, love, and even the weather. The Greeks wrote epic poems and plays about the exploits and heroism of their deities.

Ares, the god of war, is always shown prepared for battle with a helmet and spear.